

TryHackMe – Windows Basics

1. Introduction

This TryHackMe room introduced the basic features of the **Windows operating system** using a **Windows Server 2019** machine. I learned about the Windows interface, file management, application management, system settings, Task Manager, and basic security features.

2. Windows Interface

The Windows Desktop is the main workspace of the operating system. Important components include:

- **Desktop** – Main workspace for files, folders, and shortcuts.
- **Taskbar** – Provides quick access to applications and system features.
- **Start Menu** – Used to access applications, settings, files, and power options.
- **Search** – Used to quickly find applications, files, and settings.
- **Task View** – Used to view and switch between open windows.

Authentication

Windows requires users to authenticate before accessing the system. Common account types include **Guest, Standard User, and Administrator**. In this lab, I was logged in using an **Administrator account**.

3. File Management

File Explorer is used to browse and manage files and folders. Windows uses a hierarchical folder structure where folders can contain files and other folders.

In the lab, I opened the **TryHatMe Onboarding** folder and learned how to identify its file path:

C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\TryHatMe Onboarding

I also used the File Explorer search feature to locate files.

4. Application Management

Windows applications can be installed, updated, and removed.

- Applications can be installed using the Microsoft Store or trusted installer files such as .exe and .msi.
- Windows Update provides security patches and bug fixes.
- Applications can be removed through Settings, Control Panel, or their own uninstallers.

In the lab, I installed the **TryHatMeWelcome** application from the onboarding folder.

5. Windows Settings and Task Manager

Windows Settings is used to configure system, device, network, personalization, and security options. **Control Panel** is an older interface that also provides access to system configuration options.

Task Manager is used to monitor running applications, processes, and system resources such as CPU and memory.

Important Task Manager sections include:

- Processes
- Performance
- Users
- Details
- Services

6. Windows Security

Windows includes built-in security features to protect the system.

The main Windows Security areas are:

- **Virus & Threat Protection** – Detects and removes malware.
- **Firewall & Network Protection** – Controls network traffic.
- **App & Browser Control** – Helps protect against unsafe applications and websites.
- **Device Security** – Provides additional hardware-based protection.

Practical Scan

I performed a **Custom Scan** of the TryHatMe Onboarding folder using Windows Security:

1. Opened Windows Security.
2. Selected **Virus & Threat Protection**.
3. Opened **Scan Options**.
4. Selected **Custom Scan**.
5. Selected the onboarding folder and started the scan.

The lab provided a safe test file to demonstrate the detection process.

7. Windows Defender Firewall

Windows Defender Firewall monitors network traffic and uses rules to allow or block connections.

It has three main network profiles:

Profile Purpose

Domain Used for organizational domain networks

Private Used for trusted networks

Public Used for untrusted networks

The Advanced Firewall settings can be used to view and manage inbound and outbound rules.

8. Result

After completing this room, I gained practical knowledge of the Windows operating system. I learned how to navigate Windows, manage files and applications, check system activity, perform security scans, and understand the basic function of Windows Firewall.

This provided a basic foundation for further **Windows and cybersecurity learning**.

Questions in Try Hack Me:

1) After opening **About your PC**, navigate to the **Device specifications** section.

What is the **Device name** specified?

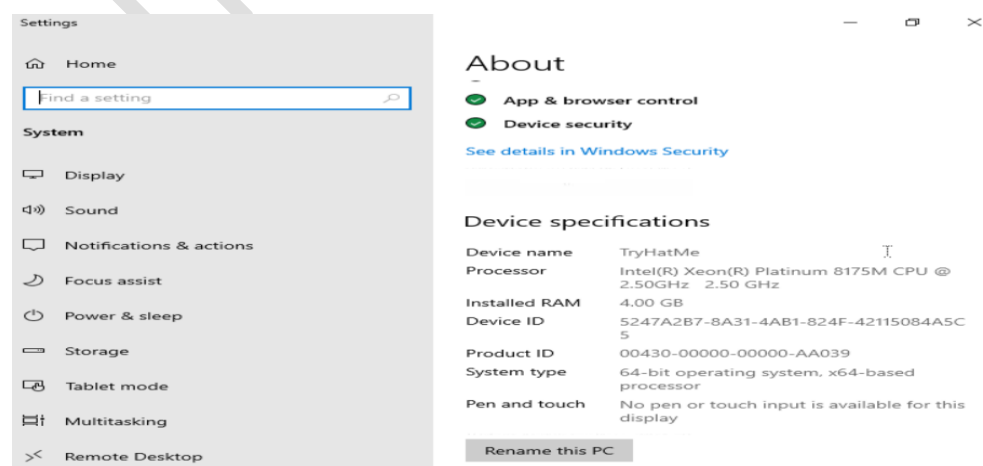
TryHatMe

2)

Continue looking through the **Device specifications**.

How much RAM is installed on your new work PC?

4.00 GB

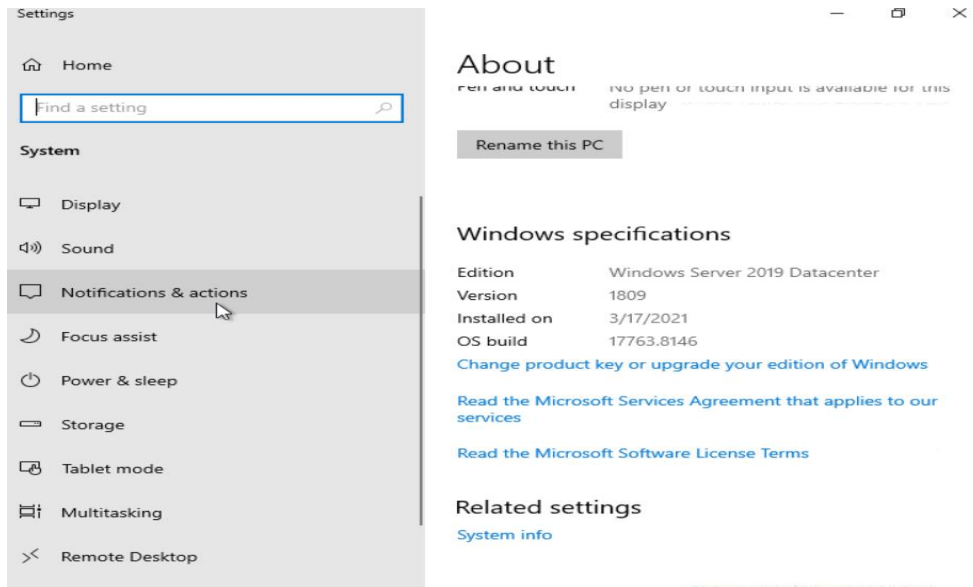


3)

Scroll down to the **Windows specifications** section.

Which **Version** of Windows Server 2019 Datacenter is installed?

1809

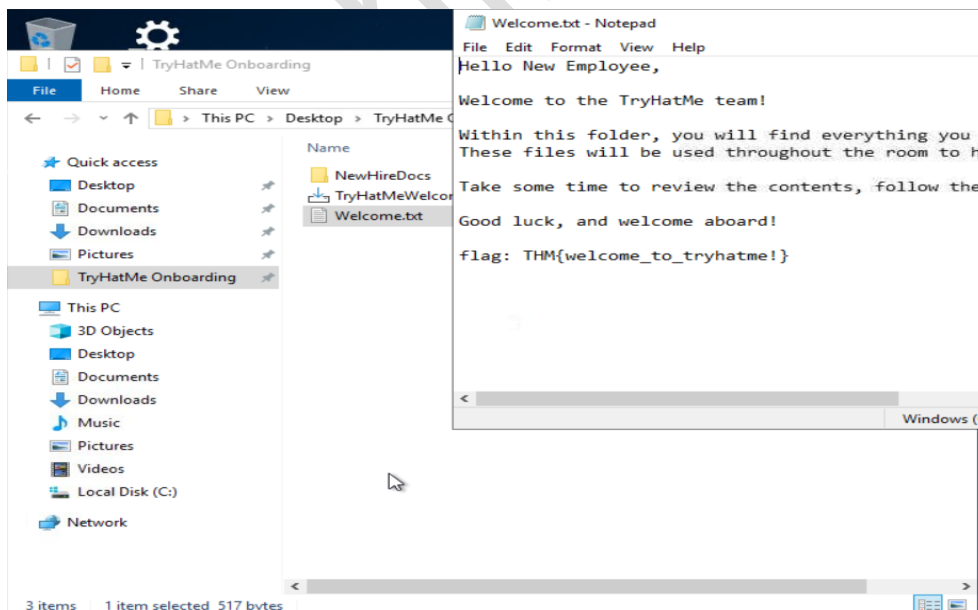


4)

Explore the TryHatMe Onboarding folder located on your computer's Desktop.

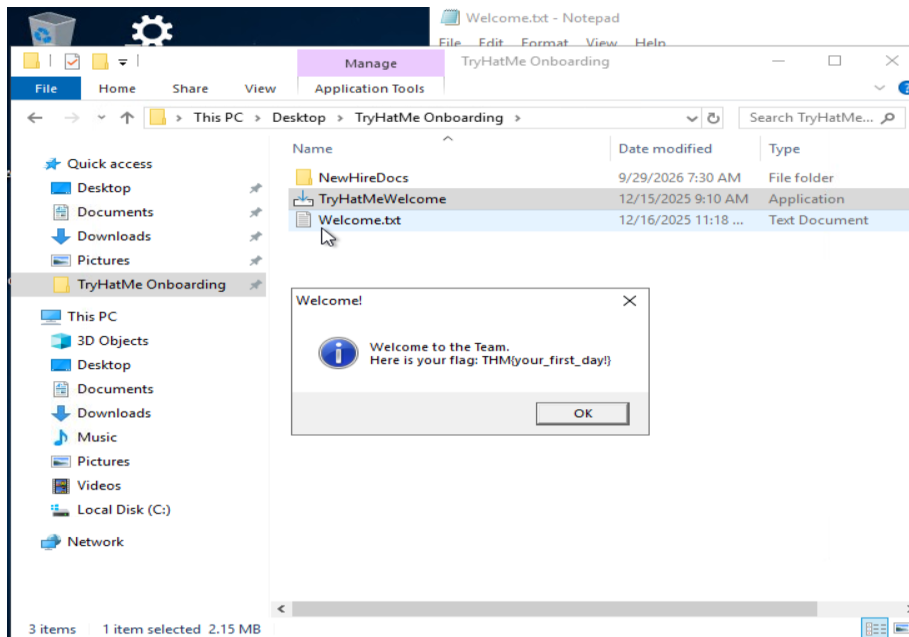
What is the flag value found within Welcome.txt?

THM{welcome_to_tryhatme!}



5) Use the TryHatMeWelcome installer located within the TryHatMe Onboarding folder. What is the flag value you receive after installing and running the application?

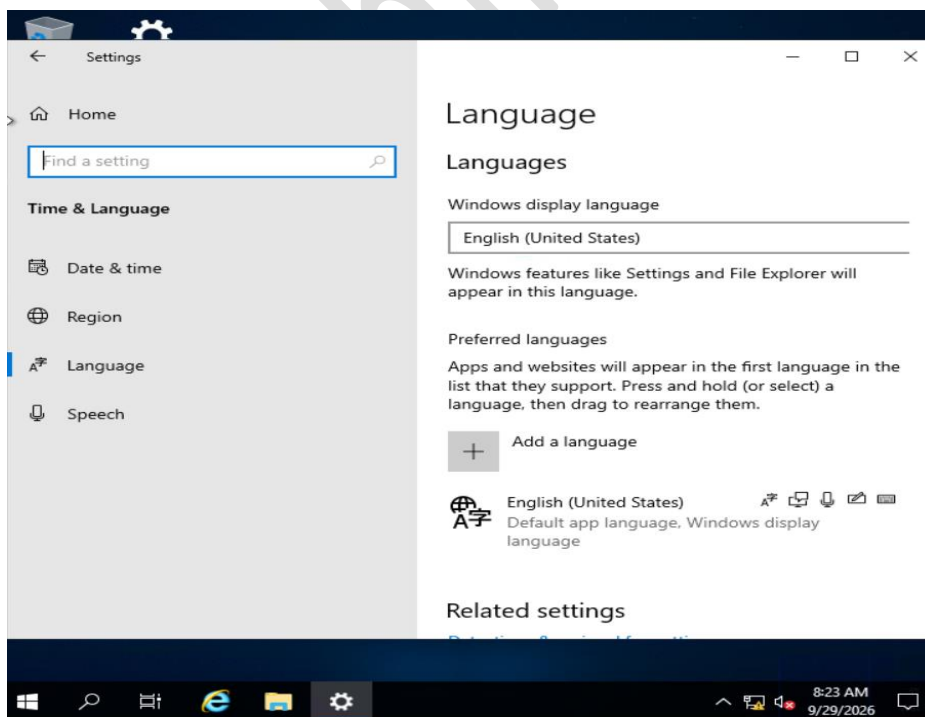
THM{your_first_day!}



6)

Investigate the **Time & Language** section of the **Windows Settings** app. Which country or region is your computer currently set to?

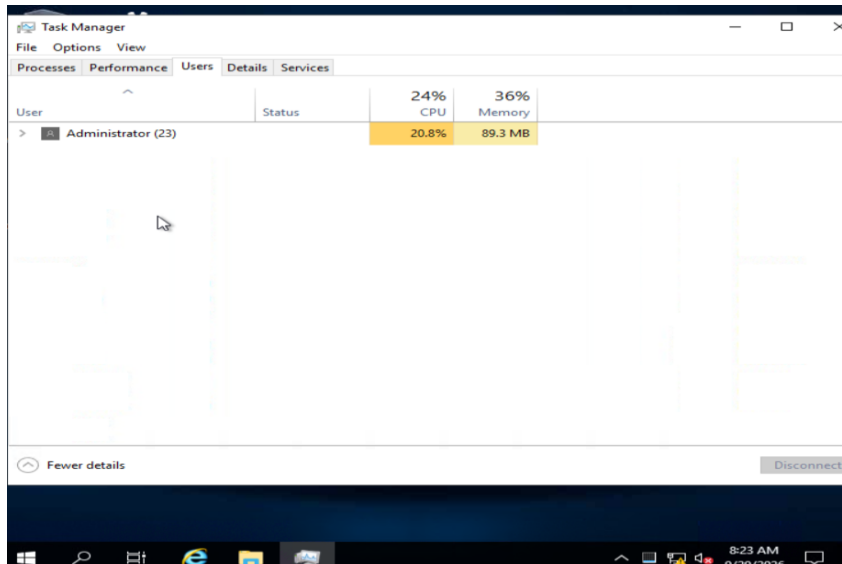
United States



7)

Open the **Task Manager** on your workstation's Desktop and navigate to the **Users** tab. Which account is currently logged in?

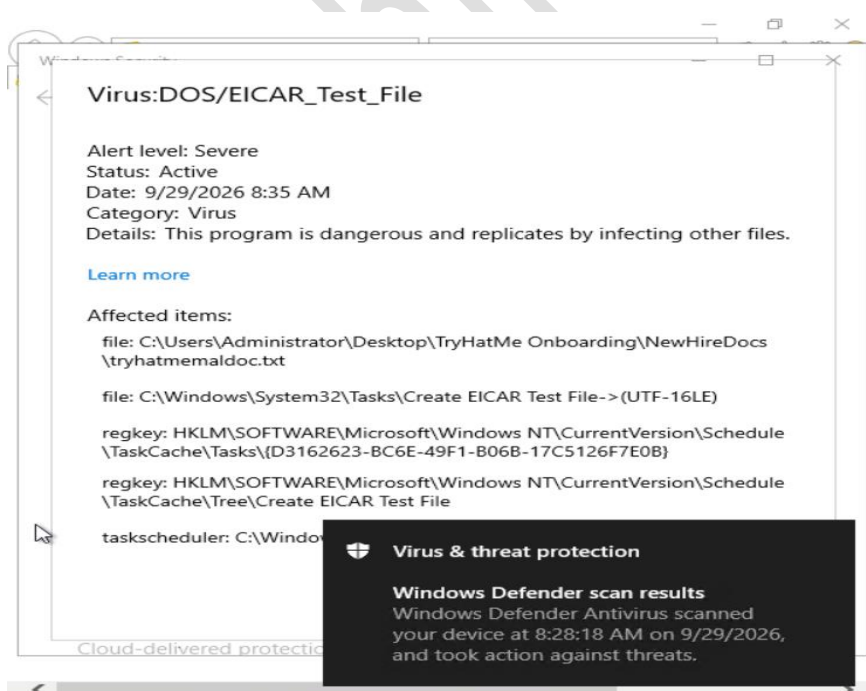
Administrator



8)

After performing your custom scan, click Virus:DOS/EICAR_Test_File and select **See details**. What is the file name shown in the **Affected items** section?

tryhatmemaldoc.txt



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